

EGGLESS HIGH-PROTEIN PEANUT BUTTER COOKIES

Gourmet peanut cookies with roasted peanut pieces and crunchy caramel praline

Yield	10 cookies	**Portion**	65–70 g each
Prep	25–30 min	**Chill**	45 min
Bake	10–13 min	**Oven**	175°C conventional / 165°C fan

Texture: lightly crisp edges, tender centre, pronounced roasted-peanut flavour and crunchy caramel praline.

Protein note: *approximately 9 g protein per cookie is a rough estimate only. Actual values depend on ingredient brands and final yield; calculate from labels before making a formal nutrition claim.*

1. Ingredients

A. Peanut praline

Ingredient	Quantity	Notes
Caster sugar	35 g	Caramel base
Roasted peanuts	40 g	Unsalted or lightly salted
Fine salt	Small pinch	Optional

B. Cookie dough

Ingredient	Quantity	Notes
Natural unsweetened peanut butter	120 g	Stir well if oil has separated
Unsalted butter, softened	45 g	Soft, not melted
Soft brown sugar	65 g	Adds moisture and chew
Caster sugar	25 g	Helps the edges crisp
Thick Greek yoghurt	50 g	Plain and unsweetened
Vanilla extract	4 g	About 1 tsp
Plain flour	75 g	Weigh accurately
Peanut protein powder	35 g	Unsweetened; absorption varies by brand
Skimmed milk powder	15 g	Adds dairy solids and protein
Baking powder	2 g	Leavening
Bicarbonate of soda	1 g	Aids browning
Fine salt	1.5 g	Reduce slightly if peanuts are salted
Roasted chopped peanuts	35 g	Small irregular pieces

Optional finish

Reserve a few praline pieces for the tops. Optionally use up to 25 g chopped dark chocolate and a small pinch of flaky salt. These are not required for the base recipe.

2. Equipment

- Digital kitchen scale, heavy-based saucepan, heatproof spatula and parchment paper.
- Mixing bowl, whisk or sturdy spatula, baking tray, baking parchment and cooling rack.
- Oven thermometer if available.

3. Method

Step 1 — Make the peanut praline

- Line a heatproof tray with baking parchment. Measure the 40 g roasted peanuts before starting.
- Put 35 g caster sugar in a clean, dry, heavy-based saucepan. Heat over medium heat, allowing the sugar to melt gradually. Gently swirl the pan if needed; avoid aggressive stirring while crystals remain.
- When the sugar is fully melted and amber, remove the pan from the heat. Carefully fold in the peanuts and a small pinch of salt. The caramel is extremely hot: never touch or taste it.
- Immediately spread the mixture thinly on the parchment. Leave undisturbed until completely cool and hard, usually 20–30 minutes depending on room temperature.
- Break the cooled praline into small irregular pieces with a sturdy knife on a stable board. Keep fingers away from the blade and reserve a few pieces for topping. Never chop warm caramel.

Safety: *Flambé is not required for peanut praline and is excluded from the core recipe. Never pour alcohol into a hot pan or near an open flame.*

Step 2 — Combine the dry ingredients

Whisk the flour, peanut protein powder, skimmed milk powder, baking powder, bicarbonate of soda and salt until evenly combined. Break up any lumps.

Step 3 — Cream butter and sugars

Beat the softened butter with both sugars for about 2 minutes using a whisk or sturdy spatula. Aim for a cohesive, slightly lighter mixture; this is not a high-volume cake-creaming stage. Scrape the bowl.

Step 4 — Add peanut butter, yoghurt and vanilla

Mix in the peanut butter until evenly incorporated. Add the yoghurt and vanilla, then stir until uniform. If the mixture looks slightly curdled, continue briefly; it should come together when the dry ingredients are added.

Step 5 — Make the dough

Fold in the dry mixture in two additions. Stop as soon as no dry flour remains. Fold in the chopped peanuts and most of the cooled praline pieces. The dough should be thick, soft and scoopable, not pourable.

Step 6 — Portion and chill

Divide into 10 portions of approximately 65–70 g each, depending on the final dough weight. Roll gently and arrange on a lined tray. Press a few reserved praline pieces into the tops if desired. Cover and chill for 45 minutes.

Step 7 — Bake

Preheat to 175°C conventional or 165°C fan-assisted. Space the chilled dough balls at least 5 cm apart; bake in batches if needed. Bake for 10–13 minutes, until the edges are set and lightly golden while the centres still look slightly soft. Do not wait for the centres to become fully firm in the oven.

Step 8 — Cool and finish

Leave on the hot tray for 10 minutes to finish setting, then transfer to a cooling rack. If using dark chocolate, press a few chopped pieces into the cookies while warm. Add flaky salt if desired. Allow to cool before judging the final texture.

4. Troubleshooting

Problem	Likely cause	Correction
Cookies spread too much	Dough too warm or peanut butter oil separated	Chill fully; stir peanut butter thoroughly; weigh ingredients accurately.
Dough is dry or crumbly	Protein powder absorbs more liquid	Add yoghurt 5 g at a time until the dough holds together; note the adjustment for your brand.
Cookies are hard	Overbaking or excess protein powder	Remove when edges are set and centres still look soft; check oven temperature.
Praline turns sticky	Humidity or incomplete cooling	Cool fully; store airtight and fold into dough shortly before baking.
Cookies brown too little	Oven too cool or excess moisture	Check oven temperature; bake until edges are set without drying the centres.

5. Storage

- Store fully cooled cookies in an airtight container at room temperature for about 3 days; hot, humid conditions may shorten this.
- Freeze baked cookies airtight for up to 2 months. Thaw at room temperature.
- Portioned unbaked dough can be frozen. Bake from frozen at the stated temperature, adding a few minutes and checking doneness.

6. Protein and nutrition note

Protein comes primarily from peanut butter, peanut protein powder, peanuts and milk powder. Around 9 g per cookie is a rough estimate for a 10-cookie yield, not a tested nutrition value. Actual protein depends on the exact brands and final baked weight. For sale or packaging, calculate from ingredient labels or arrange laboratory analysis.

7. Chef’s quality checklist

- Use a scale; small measurement errors matter in protein-enriched dough.
- Cool praline completely before chopping and folding it into the dough.
- Do not overmix once flour and protein powder are added.
- Chill the portions for the full 45 minutes.
- Remove the cookies when the edges are set; allow carry-over setting on the tray.
- Test one cookie first if changing protein powder brands, as absorption varies.